

Case Study: Phishing Attacks

Phishing is a cybercrime where attackers trick individuals into revealing their sensitive information such as passwords, bank details, or OTPs by pretending to be trusted person. A common example involves emails or messages that appear to come from official sources like banks, universities, or websites.

In a typical phishing attack, the attacker first creates a fake email or website that closely resembles an actual one. Next, they send messages to users, often creating an emergency, for example, claiming that an account will be banned or closed unless immediate action is taken. The victim clicks on the provided link, which redirects them to a fake login page. Once the user enters their credentials, the attacker stores the information and uses it for either digital fraud or to take their money.

Students are frequent targets because they actively use emails, net banking, and social media, but may not always verify sources carefully. In one realistic scenario, a student receives an email claiming to be from their university portal asking them to update credentials, trusting the email, they enter their login details and later find their account compromised.

The consequences of phishing include financial loss, identity theft, data breaches, and emotional stress. It highlights the importance of verifying sources, avoiding suspicious links, and maintaining strong cybersecurity practices.